

Lord, I want to be a Christian

Text: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907
LORD, I WANT TO BE irregular

Music: African-American spiritual,
Folk Songs of the American Negro, 1907

The musical score is written for a single voice in 4/4 time, using a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple and repetitive, with a mix of quarter, eighth, and half notes. The lyrics are arranged in four stanzas, each corresponding to a line of music. The first stanza includes four numbered variations of the lyrics. The second and fourth stanzas are identical. The third stanza is a shorter phrase. The score ends with a double bar line.

1 Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart, in my heart.
2 Lord, I want to be more lov - ing...
3 Lord, I want to be more ho - ly...
4 Lord, I want to be like Je - sus...

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.

In my heart, in my heart,

Lord, I want to be a Chris-tian in my heart.